

Preply Pricing Strategy Tutor Decision Brief

Background

Preply is a global online tutoring marketplace, founded in 2012, connecting independent tutors with students across more than 180 countries. It's not a small platform: Preply now hosts over 100,000 tutors teaching upwards of 90 languages and other subjects and reached a \$1.2 billion valuation in early 2026 after raising \$150 million. Tutors set their own rates, typically earning between \$10 and \$39 an hour depending on subject and experience, with the platform average sitting around \$18 an hour. In a marketplace this size, a tutor competing for visibility isn't one of a handful of options, they're one of tens of thousands.

I'm one of those tutors, and I'm also a data analyst. For most of the time I've taught on Preply, those two things ran in parallel without ever really touching, I made pricing decisions the way most tutors probably do, on instinct, competitor glancing, and gut feel, while separately building analytical skills for an entirely different career path.

This project is where those two sides of me finally met. Instead of leaving my own business decisions to instinct, I turned my own tutoring data, real students, real prices, real income, into the same kind of analysis I was hoping to eventually get paid to do for someone else. In a marketplace where over 100,000 tutors are quietly competing for the same pool of students, I didn't want to leave my pricing to chance. I wanted the data to tell me what was working.

Decision

Progressively increase price over time, from a starting point of \$5 up to \$25, using temporary reductions as a recovery tool whenever acquisition weakens at a new price ceiling, then pushing higher again working toward a sustainable target of roughly 8 hours a day, 5 days a week, rather than the higher-volume, longer-hours pattern low pricing had originally required.

North Star Metrics

Metric	Result
Trial-to-return rate	47.1% (374 trials → 176 returned)
Monthly earnings range (post-baseline)	\$1,240 – \$1,812, held steady
Monthly lessons taught	Declined from 283 (March) to 164 (August)
Gross vs. Net pay	\$46.31K gross → \$28.91K net (≈37.6% platform commission)
Price range tested	\$5 → \$25

5K

Lessons Taught

46,31K

Gross Pay

28,91K

Net Pay

Recommendations

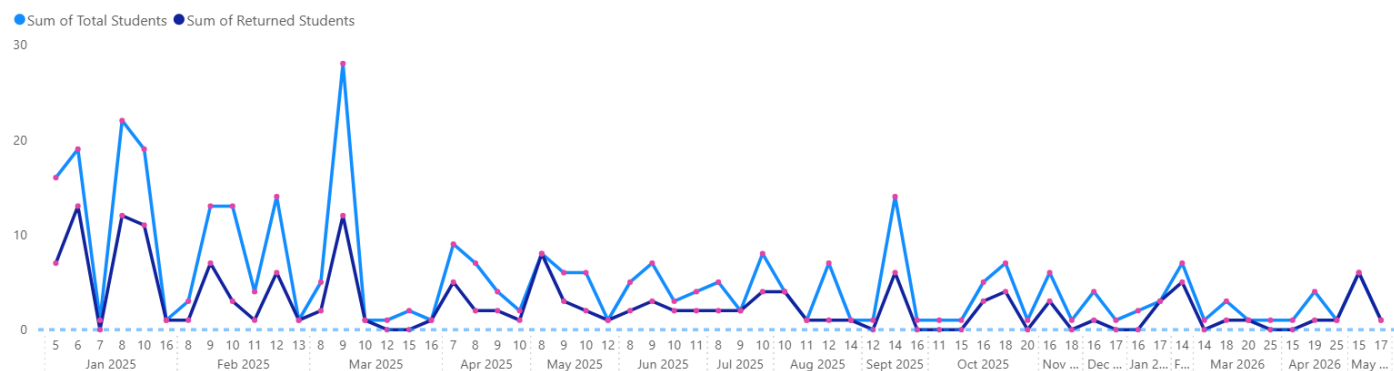
Recommendation	Owner	Target	Metric
1.Continue raising baseline price in gradual increments rather than large jumps	Tutor	Next price test within 30 days	Acquisition volume at new price point vs. prior ceiling
2.Apply a temporary price reduction whenever a new ceiling shows very low acquisition	Tutor	Reduction triggered within 2–4 weeks of a weak result	Return to baseline acquisition volume within 1 month
3.Deliberately cap working hours at ~8–9 hours/day, 5 days/week, using price as the lever to sustain income at that lower volume	Tutor	Ongoing, re-assessed monthly	Monthly lesson count converted to hours taught, vs. target hour ceiling
4.Investigate why Poland over-indexes on both volume (24.45%) and revenue (26.70%)	Marketing/channel research	Identify likely acquisition channel driving Poland demand	Confirm or rule out a specific channel

Evidence

Recommendation 1: Continue raising baseline price in gradual increments rather than large jumps

In January and February 2025, I was still pricing to fill my calendar, not to protect my time. Jan–Mar 2025 (establishing the baseline): low prices (\$5–\$9) produced strong volume at \$5 → 16/7, \$6 → 19/13, \$8 → 22/12, \$9 → 28/12 (the strongest single result in the dataset) while \$16 in the same window returned almost nothing (1/1).

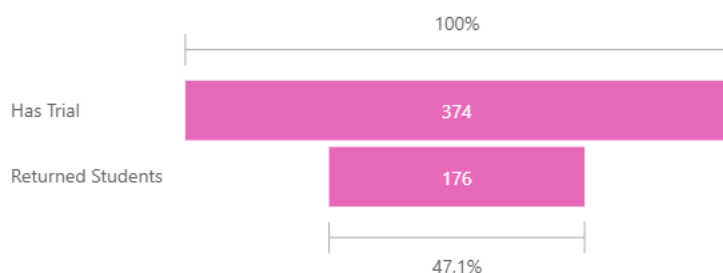
Increased Price Incrementally With Temporary Reductions To Increase Demand And Conversion Rate



Two years in, I'm charging prices I wouldn't have believed at the start, and students are still showing up. Price ceiling extended well beyond the original range: by 2026, price had climbed through \$18, \$20, and up to \$25. Results at \$18 in June 2026 (11 acquired / 6 returned) show the ceiling isn't just being tested, it's producing real, meaningful volume even at more than double the original starting price.

Not every student who tries a trial sticks around, but enough do to build a real business on, confirming this isn't just attracting one-off bargain hunters as price rises. Nearly half of trial students convert into repeat business: 374 recorded trials → 176 returning students → 47.1%.

47.1% of Students Subscribed



Recommendation 2: Apply a temporary price reduction whenever a new ceiling shows very low acquisition

Every time I pushed my price up too fast, I felt it, bookings would go quiet, and I'd have to walk it back. That wasn't a failure, it was the strategy working exactly as

designed. Recovery pattern repeated: May 2025's \$12 (1/1) recovered via June's \$8–9 (5–7 students); Sept 2025's \$16 (1/0) recovered via \$14 (14/6).

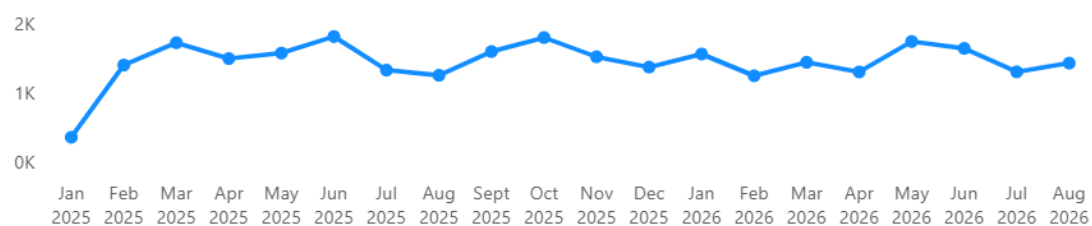
Recommendation 3: My income barely moved while I taught fewer lessons by deliberately capping working hours while sustaining income through pricing.

By August 2025, the pattern was clear: fewer lessons weren't costing me money, they were the point. Raising price, not adding hours, was what kept my income steady.

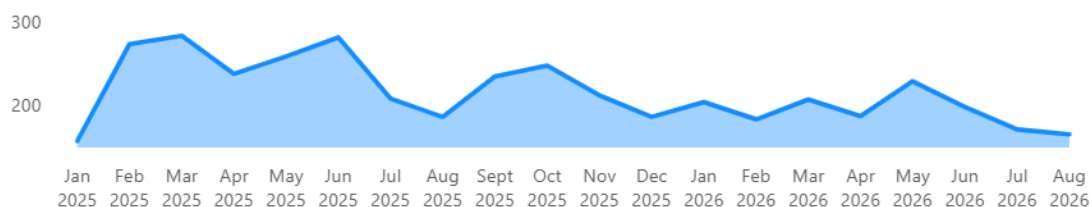
Keep capping working hours toward 8–9 hours a day, 5 days a week, letting the same gradual price increases from Recommendations 1 and 2 carry the income, not added volume.

Mar 2025 → 283 lessons / \$1,723.25. Jun 2025 → 281 / \$1,812.61. Oct 2025 → 247 / \$1,798.26. May 2026 → 228 / \$1,741.27. Lessons down ~20%, earnings held within \$1,240 – \$1,812 throughout.

Monthly Earnings Rose And Remained in A Stable Range Between \$1812 And \$1240 Over Time



Working Hours Declined Over Time From 283 Lessons in March to 164 in August



Recommendation 4: Investigate why Poland over-indexes on both volume and revenue

When I looked at where my students actually come from, one country kept showing up again and again. Poland represents 24.45% of lessons booked and 26.70% of total earnings, ahead of Spain and Italy.

Top 10:

Poland Represents 24.45% of total lessons booked

Student Location

● Poland
● Spain
● Italy
● Germany
● France
● Brazil
● Canada
● Ukraine
● Turkey
● Portugal



26.70% of Total Earnings Come from Polish Students



Caveats

- Prices weren't returned to \$5–8 after March 2025, so repeat volume at that level isn't proven, only observed once.
- Results above \$18 remain thin, mostly single bookings, so \$25 should be read as an active ceiling test, not a proven sustainable price.
- The 47.1% conversion figure is a lower-bound-friendly proxy, not a true attended-trial rate, due to a data limitation in how Preply logs no-shows.
- The underlying dataset itself is limited in scope, no lesson-length-to-hours conversion, no marketing/channel data, no student demographic detail beyond location, so several findings (like the Poland concentration) can only be surfaced as leads for further investigation, not fully explained within this analysis alone.

Outlook

Gradual price increases in the \$18–\$25 range appear to still be absorbing real demand rather than hitting a hard ceiling, June 2026's \$18 result is the strongest evidence of this. A reasonable next test would be sustained pricing in the \$20–\$22 range with a temporary reduction ready to deploy if acquisition drops sharply, mirroring the pattern already validated twice in this dataset. This is directional based on the pattern so far, not guaranteed, the small sample at the top of the price range means each new \$20+ data point meaningfully shifts the picture. If \$20–22 sustains close to a 40-hour weeks' worth of lessons at comparable income, that would validate the target directly.